

Site Sensei: HTML & CSS Mini Website Rubric

Sample classroom rubric for beginner web-development projects

This sample rubric is designed to pair with Site Sensei. Automated checks can evaluate many HTML/CSS requirements, while design choices, planning, and revision still benefit from teacher or peer review.

Criteria	Exceeds Expectations	Meets Expectations	Developing	Beginning
HTML Structure & Content	Uses 8 or more different HTML element types, including a main heading, additional headings, paragraphs, images, lists, and links. Content is organized clearly, and the page renders with few or no structural errors.	Uses the expected core HTML elements, including headings, paragraphs, images, and links. Most content is organized inside appropriate elements and the page renders correctly with only minor issues.	Uses some required HTML elements, but several expected elements are missing or used inconsistently. Structural or syntax issues may affect parts of the page.	Uses very few appropriate HTML elements, or major structural/syntax problems prevent the page from rendering or being understood correctly.
CSS Styling & Organization	Uses an external stylesheet and 8 or more different CSS properties. Styling choices are consistent, readable, and support the organization and purpose of the page.	Uses CSS to style the page with several properties. Most styling is consistent and helps make the page readable and organized.	Uses some CSS, but styling is limited, inconsistent, or only partially connected to the page structure.	Uses little or no CSS, or styling errors prevent the page from displaying as intended.
Code Quality & Debugging	HTML and CSS are kept in appropriate files, indentation and whitespace make the code easy to follow, comments are used where helpful, and errors have been corrected through testing.	Code is generally readable and organized. HTML and CSS are mostly separated appropriately, with only minor formatting or debugging issues.	Code works in parts but formatting is inconsistent, files may not be organized clearly, or several unresolved errors remain.	Code is difficult to read or maintain, and major unresolved errors interfere with the webpage.
Navigation, Media & Attribution	Links work as intended, images display correctly and include useful alternative text when appropriate, and image/source credits are provided when required.	Most links and images work correctly. Attribution is included for outside media when required.	Some links or images are missing, broken, or unclear, and attribution may be incomplete.	Links or images are largely missing or broken, or required attribution is not provided.
Iteration & Reflection	Uses feedback to make thoughtful revisions and can explain specific improvements made to the webpage. Reflection clearly describes choices, challenges, and next steps.	Responds to feedback with reasonable revisions and completes a reflection describing the project and learning.	Makes limited revisions or gives a brief reflection with few details.	Shows little evidence of revision, feedback use, or reflection.

Suggested automated Site Sensei checks: HTTP/page access status; HTML element counts and variety; headings; paragraphs; images; lists; links; class usage; external CSS detection; CSS property counts; image-credit indicators; comments; and selected structural issues.

Teacher/peer review recommended for: design quality, alignment with a project plan, code readability beyond simple checks, quality of revisions, peer feedback, and reflection.